APPBUILDERSPH HACKATHON 2026 · THEME: LOCAL AI · OCT 9

Idea shortlist

Five product ideas for the challenge **“Build an AI product that remains genuinely useful when the cloud disappears.”** Each one is checked against the judging criteria and the rules in the briefing.

RECOMMENDED **A · Basa, offline reading test for teachers**

FROM THE BRIEFING

What the brief demands

2:30 PM · Oct 9

Building starts. Remote, overnight.

10:00 AM · Oct 10

Submission deadline. One submission, no edits, no extensions. Repo frozen at the deadline.

1:00 PM · Oct 10

10 to 15 finalists announced at Cyberzone, SM Makati.

5 + 3 min

Live pitch and demo, then judge Q&A. Someone from the team must be on site.

How it is scored

25	25	20	15	15

25 · Problem & usefulness

25 · Local AI implementation

20 · Technical execution

15 · Innovation

15 · Product & demo quality

Half the score is usefulness plus how real the local AI is.

MUST ANSWER

Why does this product benefit from running AI locally? The strongest answers stack reasons: impossible offline, private, too expensive at scale, too slow through the cloud.

WIN MOVE

Turn Wi-Fi off on stage and keep working. Fake benchmarks are grounds for disputing results, so show live proof on screen: an offline

	badge, the model name, the latency.
DELIVERABLES	Public GitHub repo, a demo video of about 1 minute, an X or LinkedIn post tagging Devin / Cognition with #AppBuildersPH, and disclosure of models, frameworks, APIs, existing code and AI dev tools.
HARDWARE	Build PC: GTX 1650 (4GB VRAM), 32GB RAM, no Ollama yet. Target a 4B-class LLM plus Whisper turbo. Whatever we build must also run on the demo laptop.
PRIZES	Grand Champion **₱50,000** · WhiteCloak **₱15,000** · Cognition / Devin **₱10,000** · AMD **₱10,000** · People's Choice **₱10,000** · Tutorials Dojo **4 × ₱10,000** Special awards can be won on top of the main award.

OUR READ

At a glance

Which why-local reasons each idea can claim, how risky the build is, and the moment that sells it on stage.

IDEA	OFFLINE	PRIVATE	COST AT SCALE	SPEED	RISK	CPU-ONLY LAPT
A · Basa	○	○	○	○	Low	Yes
B · Ngiti	○	○	○	○	Low	Yes
C · Kapit	○	○	○	○	High	Slow with many phones

D · Tsek	○	○	○	○	High	No, too slow
E · Takip	○	○	○	○	Medium	Yes

○ Strong reason ○ Partial ○ Does not apply

FIVE CANDIDATES

The ideas

A Basa

RECOMMENDED

Offline reading test for public school teachers

PROBLEM	Teachers run Phil-IRI oral reading tests by ear, with a stopwatch and a tally sheet, one child at a time. The Philippine reading crisis is national news.
PRODUCT	A child reads a graded passage aloud. Local Whisper with word timestamps, plus word alignment, marks each miscue (skipped word, wrong word, extra word) and computes words per minute and the Phil-IRI level. A local LLM asks comprehension questions and grades the spoken answers. Class dashboard and CSV export. When online, only scores sync, never audio.
WHY LOCAL	Children's voices never leave the room. Many schools lack internet. Millions of learners take 2 tests a year, at ₱0 each. Feedback per word is instant.
DEMO	A judge reads a passage with Wi-Fi off. Words turn green or red live. Click a red word to replay how it was read.
STACK	`faster-whisper` large-v3-turbo · `difflib` (Python stdlib) for alignment · 4B model on Ollama · FastAPI + one HTML page · SQLite

RISK	Whisper tends to write the expected word instead of the misread one, and kids' voices are harder to transcribe. Fix: don't give Whisper the passage as a prompt, have the teacher confirm each flag, and run an honest mini-eval on 5–10 recordings.

B Ngiti

ALT PICK

Hands-free dental charting

PROBLEM	Gloved hands can't type, so charting needs an assistant or gets done later from memory.
PRODUCT	Push-to-talk with a foot pedal (any USB key). The dentist says, in Taglish, “36 MO caries, 46 missing, perio 3-2-3”. Local speech recognition plus an LLM with a JSON schema fills the odontogram and perio chart live, then drafts a treatment plan and a Tagalog explanation for the patient.
WHY LOCAL	Dental records are sensitive personal information under the Data Privacy Act. Clinic Wi-Fi is flaky. All-day dictation costs ₱0.
DEMO	Talk, and the teeth change color live in airplane mode.
EDGE	Existing dental clinic client work means credible Q&A answers and a buyer list after the event. Build it fresh: reusing old clinic code risks a pre-existing-project dispute.
RISK	Niche, and tooth numbers can be misheard. Fix: code validates FDI tooth numbers, and each change gets a confirm chip.

C Kapit

Barangay offline AI hub

PROBLEM	After a typhoon, cell towers and internet can be down for days. Residents need first-aid and evacuation answers, and the barangay captain needs a report of what people need.

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PRODUCT	A laptop plus a ₱1–2k travel router with no internet acts as the hub. Residents scan a QR code and use the web app on their own phones, with nothing to install. They ask in Tagalog, and answers cite official manuals (local RAG). They report needs by voice or photo; local AI sorts them and writes the situation report.
WHY LOCAL	The cloud is gone, which is the challenge statement itself.
DEMO	Judges scan the QR code and use the hub from their own phones while it is offline. Strong People's Choice potential.
RISK	Highest of the five. Expect several disaster chatbots at the event. One laptop serving many phones will be slow, stage networking can fail, and first-aid answers can be wrong.

D Tsek

Handwritten quiz checker

PROBLEM	Teachers check hundreds of papers by hand every day.
PRODUCT	Photograph a stack of quizzes. A local vision model reads the handwriting, grades against the answer key, flags answers it is unsure of, and exports the class record.
WHY LOCAL	Students' data stays private, it works in offline schools, and there is no per-page API cost.
RISK	A small vision model on a 4GB GPU misreads handwriting and is slow on CPU. Biggest accuracy risk of the five.

E Takip

HYBRID

Privacy firewall for BPO agents

PROBLEM	Agents paste customer personal data into ChatGPT, so companies

ban it.